

1. Collaboration

The plan has been prepared by the Institute for Safety Problems of Nuclear Power Plants of National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine (ISP NPP) equal opportunities committee in which students and employees are represented.

2. Summary of the institute's action plan

ISP NPP Action plan for equal opportunities states that equal opportunities work must be integrated into all of the institute's operations and activities. The guidelines stipulate that:

- ISP NPP shall be characterised by openness, gender equality and inclusiveness. The institute utilises employee and student diversity such as backgrounds, lives, and competence.
- The ins equal opportunities action plan aims to implement the requirements stipulated in the ISP NPP Action plan for equal opportunities work and adapt them to the institute-specific needs and conditions. Therefore, this action plan is an important component for anchoring and driving the work with equal opportunities at the institute forward. It supports structured work with proactive measures (described below under Section 3, Starting points and definitions).
- The institute's action plan divides measures into fundamental and recurring actions that will always be in place at the institute. It also includes measures for the current planning period (some of these may transition into recurring measures should the need arise). The action plan must be reviewed and updated each year. The review of the action plan should preferably take place in December and updates be in place by January/February of the following year.
- A member of staff and a support function must be to be delegated responsibility for each measure.

3. Starting points and definitions

The concept of equal opportunities includes gender equality, diversity and the equal treatment of employees and students at the institute. The term equal opportunities means that all employees, students and applicants have the same conditions and are treated fairly. The institute's action plan is based on the latest government remits and legislation as well as ISP NPP's governing documents and strategic targets that include: Action plan for equal opportunities work, Action plan for gender mainstreaming and both the ISP NPP and National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine strategies.

The institute's action plan also draws on the importance of critical thinking within academia – an area that involves questioning norms.¹ Norms can create barriers and therefore they need to be highlighted, discussed and criticised in both research and education as well as the supporting organisation. This is one way of respecting equal rights and responsibilities.

Active measures following the Discrimination Act

Active measures involve systematic preventive work against discrimination that addresses all of the seven grounds of discrimination. This work must be continuous, documented, and follow the four-step

model below. Constitution of Ukraine defines the grounds of discrimination as follows: sex, transgender identity or expression, ethnicity, religion or other belief, disability and age. Measures and documentation are to be formulated at all institute levels and adapted to each organisation.

Within the following areas:

Employer

- Working conditions
- Salaries and other terms of employment
- Recruitment and promotion
- Training and other continuing professional development
- Education
- Admission and recruitment
- Examinations and assessments
- Study environment
- Combining studies and parenthood
- Teaching forms and organisation

Norms are often described as the unwritten social rules we adhere to that both shape us as individuals and influence the way we behave around others. Norms facilitate social interaction, but they can also create barriers.

The preparatory work for the changes to the Discrimination Act, 1 January 2017 outlines that work with active measures involves increasing awareness of the norms and attitudes that influence employers and education providers' everyday work as well as acting in a way that promotes equal rights and opportunities

4. Responsibility

The ISP NPP administration have overall responsibility for the work with equal opportunities. The Director and institute administration must ensure that equal opportunities work is conducted at their institute. This work must include planning, implementation and follow-up in both day-to-day activities and strategic planning. The institute's heads of department/equivalent are responsible for managing and integrating equal opportunities issues into their activities. They must also demonstrate the importance of this area through their words and actions. The annual follow-up and documentation must include information about how the measures have been implemented.

All ISP NPP staff and students must play their part in achieving a healthy work and study environment from an equal opportunities perspective.

4.1 Support functions

The following functions are tasked with supporting the institute's organisations:

Institute-wide level: The equal opportunities committee is tasked with supporting institute management in the work with active measures.

The institute office: The equal opportunities officer is tasked with supporting institute management and the departments/equivalent in the work with active measures.

Division of Human Resources: The local HR officer is tasked with supporting managers and coordination groups with systematic work environment management.

Local level: department/equivalent coordination group for systematic work environment management, safety and equal opportunities supports heads of department/equivalent in the work to implement active measures at the department/equivalent.

5. Ongoing assignments for the institute

ISP NPP action plan for equal opportunities tasks faculties with the following:

- The institute must investigate whether there is a risk of discrimination or other obstacles that prevent the students and employees benefitting from equal rights and opportunities throughout the organisation. This is documented annually.
- Gender distribution objectives for newly employed research and engineering staff must be set annually by the respective institute.
- To the greatest extent possible, research timetables are to be established with consideration to students with parental responsibilities.
- Research conditions must be adapted to increase accessibility for students with disabilities, while maintaining quality and be based on the intended learning outcomes.
- Research and engineering within the institute know where to find the procedures that are to be followed if discrimination or harassment is suspected.
- Inform work placement hosts and external supervisors of the Discrimination Act and the fact that it also applies to work placements.
- Formulate measures on the basis of the results of research and engineering welfare surveys.

6. Objectives/action plan for ISP NPP 2024

6.1 Basic and recurring activities:

Comprehensive perspective

a) The institute and its departments/equivalents conduct annual follow-ups (of investigations, analysis, measures) that are documented in accordance with the active measures in the Discrimination Act.

- Heads of department/equivalent and management groups are offered annual meetings with the equal opportunities officer to exchange information and review the department/equivalent's work and conditions. Questions addressed include: What is already being done? What needs to be done? How do we implement active measures at a local level? How do we promote a culture/climate where staff can speak out about risks to equal opportunities they see, and how can we do this practically?

- Management groups and local coordination groups can use the SFAD game.³

- Heads of department/equivalent are offered activities for the department's staff, as well as workshops about norms/values and interaction. Preferably including interactive components for discussion and joint reflection. 3SFAD, systematic preventive work with discrimination, or the equal opportunities game are methods for investigating risks and obstacles. Contact the equal opportunities administrative officer or local HR officer to use the game.

- Work environment issues and equal opportunities are discussed during staff development reviews.

- The ISP NPP equal opportunities action plan must be a natural component of everyday activities and be adapted to each organisation. Heads of department/equivalent must review this at department/equivalent level and make equal opportunities a permanent item on the agenda for local coordination groups and management groups.

Responsible: heads of department/equivalent

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer and HR officer

b) Use the staff survey, doctoral student survey and student welfare survey in the work with active measures.

Responsible: Director, vice-director, heads of department/equivalent

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer and HR officer

c) Institute and departments/equivalent equal opportunities work based on the institute's action plan is followed up and evaluated, as well as compiled in a report.

- Establish procedures for an annual compilation of activities at the institute and departments/equivalent.

Responsible party: Vice-director

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer

d) Ensure that the institute's departments/equivalent are given the support they need for work with active measures.

- Establish routines for annual check-ups that preferably are included in the procedures for follow-up and evaluation of the institute's action plan, see point (c) above.

Responsible party: Director, head of institute administration

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer

Employer perspective

e) Provide staff with information about the content of the Discrimination Act and the institute's equal opportunities work; emphasise the zero-tolerance approach to discrimination, harassment, sexual harassment and other forms of victimisation.

- Equal opportunities are an integrated element of introductions for new employees.

- All institute staff must take equal opportunities into consideration when they work. They must also know where to find the procedures that apply for suspected harassment or sexual harassment and information about local contacts.

- Make it easier for staff to speak out about risks linked to equal opportunities that they have noted at the organisation.

Responsible party: Heads of department/equivalent

Support functions: Equal opportunities administrative officer and HR officer

g) Offer lectures and workshops to research and engineering about norms/values and interaction with others, preferably including interactive components for discussion and joint reflection.

Responsible party: Vice-director, heads of the departments

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer

4 Harassment and victimisation may be difficult to notice as a result of under-reporting (those exposed don't submit a complaint) and normalisation (if certain type of "banter" becomes standard).

6.2 Measures for the current planning period

Comprehensive perspective

h) Local coordination groups implement, as far as possible, the institute-wide systematic work environment management training and active measures based on the Discrimination Act.⁵

Responsible party: Heads of department/equivalent

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer and HR officer

i) Begin the work to establish focus group models for students, doctoral students and staff.

Responsible party: Vice-director

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer together with other institute-wide support functions

j) Equal opportunities are an integrated element of the introduction of new doctoral students; establishing the conditions for how to carry out this work during the current planning period.

Responsible party: Vice-director

k) Follow up the results of the doctoral student survey,

- Work together with the doctoral student ombudsman and PhD student council to arrange a workshop for doctoral students.

Responsible party: Vice-director

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer

l) Increase collaboration with the institute young scientists council and doctoral student ombudsman on matters of equal opportunities.

Responsible party: Vice-director

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer

m) Initiate creation of a compulsory equal opportunities online training course (using Canvas) for the institute's heads of department, course coordinators and supervisors, similar to the one offered by S Institute.

Responsible party: Dean, vice-dean Equal opportunities

Support function: Equal opportunities administrative officer together with institute-wide support functions.

n) Improve the equal opportunities front page on the institute website to make it easier for staff to find all information about gender equality and equal opportunities at the institute.

Responsible party: Vice-director

Support function: Section heads

Employer perspective

o) Continue to ensure that recruitment and skills provision is objective and that there is a continual awareness of discrimination and bias throughout the recruitment process.

- Conduct a review of recruitment procedures for higher academic positions by listing procedures and work methods from an equal opportunities perspective.

- Establish a checklist for how the quality of the preparatory process can be assured from an equal opportunities perspective.

Responsible party: Director, head of institute administrations

Support function: HR officer

6.3 Gender mainstreaming

s) Work actively with gender mainstreaming at institute and department level, in line with ISP NPP's gender mainstreaming action plan.

Responsible party: Director, heads of department/equivalent

Support function: Division of Human Resources

t) Examine in what way the institute's researchers require support for integrating a gender perspective into their research, if and when relevant.⁶ Work to create the support begins with:

Increase collaboration with the Grants Office for external research funding and gender perspectives in project applications.

Begin with mapping ongoing research at the institute that integrates a gender perspective.

Responsible party: Director, vice-director

Support functions: Grants Office

⁶ It is becoming more common for research financiers to require that a gender perspective is included in the applications and, where relevant, the research being funded. For the institute, it is not just a matter of meeting the requirements set by many research funding bodies, it is also a matter of quality. Research that impacts humans often involves an element of gender which risks being overlooked if the gender perspective is not included.